blessed them, 8 and spake unto them, saying, Return with much wealth unto your tents, and with very much cattle, with silver, and with gold, and with brass, and with iron, and with very much raiment: divide the spoil of your enemies with your brethren. 9 And the children of Reuben and the children of Gad and the half-tribe of Manasseh returned, and departed from the children of Israel out of Shiloh, which is in the land of Canaan, to go unto the land of Gilead, to the land of their possession, whereof they were possessed, according to the commandment of Jehovah by Moses.

10 And when they came unto the region about the Jordan, that is in the land of Canaan, the children of Reuben and the children of Gad and the half-tribe of Manasseh built there an altar by the Jordan, a great altar to look upon. 11 And the children of Israel heard say, Behold, the children of Reuben and the children of Gad and the half-tribe of Manasseh have built [a] an altar in the forefront of the land of Canaan, in the region about the Jordan, on the side that pertaineth to the children of Israel. 12 And when the children of Israel heard of it, the whole congregation of the children of Israel gathered themselves together at [b] Shiloh, to go up against them to war.

13 And the children of Israel sent unto the children of Reuben, and to the children of Gad, and to the half-tribe of Manasseh, into the land of Gilead, [c] Phinehas the son of Eleazar the priest, 14 and with him ten princes, one prince of a fathers' house for each of the tribes of Israel; and they were every one of them head of their fathers' houses among the [1] thousands of Israel. 15 And they came unto the children of Reuben, and to the children of Gad, and to the half-tribe of Manasseh, unto the land of Gilead, and they spake with them, saying, 16 Thus saith the whole congregation of Jehovah, What trespass is this that ye have committed against the God of Israel, to turn away this day from following Jehovah, in that ye have builded you [d] an altar, to rebel this day against Jehovah? 17 Is [e] the iniquity of Peor too little for us, from which we have not cleansed ourselves unto this day, although there came a plague upon the congregation of Jehovah, 18 that ye must turn away this day from following Jehovah? and it will be, seeing ye rebel to-day against Jehovah, that to-morrow he will be wroth with the whole congregation of Israel. 19 Howbeit, if the land of your possession be unclean, then pass ye over unto the land of the possession of Jehovah, wherein Jehovah's [f] tabernacle dwelleth, and take possession among us: but rebel not against Jehovah, nor rebel against us, in building you an altar besides the altar of Jehovah our God. 20 Did not [g] Achan the son of Zerah commit a trespass in the devoted thing, and wrath fell upon all the congregation of Israel? and that man perished not alone in his iniquity.

21 Then the children of Reuben and the children of Gad and the half-tribe of Manasseh answered, and spake unto the heads of the [1] thousands of Israel, 22 The Mighty One, God, Jehovah, the Mighty One, God, Jehovah, he knoweth; and Israel he shall know: if it be in rebellion, or if in trespass against Jehovah (save thou us not this day), 23 that we have built us an altar to turn away from following Jehovah; or [h] if to offer thereon burnt-offering or meal-offering, or if to offer sacrifices of peace-offerings thereon, let Jehovah himself require it; 24 and if we have not *rather* out of carefulness done this, *and* of purpose, saying, In time to come your children might speak unto our children, saying, What have ye to do with Jehovah, the God of Israel? 25 for Jehovah hath made the Jordan a border between us and you, ye children of Reuben and children of Gad; ye have no portion in Jehovah: so might your children make our children cease from fearing Jehovah. 26 Therefore we said, Let us now prepare to build us an altar, not for burnt-offering, nor for sacrifice: 27 but it shall be a witness between us and you, and between our generations after us, that we may do the service of Jehovah before him with our burnt-offerings, and with our sacrifices, and with our peace-offerings; that your children may not say to our children in time to come,

[a] ver. 19; Dt. 12. 5
[b] ch. 18. 1
[c] Num. 25. 7, 11; 31. 6
[d] ver. 11
[e] Num. 25. 1-9
[f] ver. 11
[g] ch. 7. 1-26
[h] Dt. 12. 11

[1] Or, *families*

Ye have no portion in Jehovah. 28 Therefore said we, It shall be, when they so say to us or to our generations in time to come, that we shall say, Behold the pattern of the altar of Jehovah, which our fathers made, not for burnt-offering, nor for sacrifice; but it is a witness between us and you. 29 Far be it from us that we should rebel against Jehovah, and turn away this day from following Jehovah, to build an altar for burnt-offering, for meal-offering, or for sacrifice, besides the altar of Jehovah our God that is before his tabernacle.

30 And when Phinehas the priest, and the princes of the congregation, even the heads of the thousands of Israel that were with him, heard the words that the children of Reuben and the children of Gad and the children of Manasseh spake, it pleased them well. 31 And Phinehas the son of Eleazar the priest said unto the children of Reuben, and to the children of Gad, and to the children of Manasseh, This day we know that Jehovah is in the midst of us, because ye have not committed this trespass against Jehovah: now have ye delivered the children of Israel out of the hand of Jehovah. 32 And Phinehas the son of Eleazar the priest, and the princes, returned from the children of Reuben, and from the children of Gad, out of the land of Gilead, unto the land of Canaan, to the children of Israel, and brought them word again. 33 And the thing pleased the children of Israel; and the children of Israel blessed God, and spake no more of going up against them to war, to destroy the land wherein the children of Reuben and the children of Gad dwelt. 34 And the children of Reuben and the children of Gad [a]called the altar [1]*Ed*: For, *said they*, it is a witness between us that Jehovah is God.

23 And it came to pass after many days, when Jehovah had given [b]rest unto Israel from all their enemies round about, and Joshua was old and well stricken in years; 2 [c]that Joshua called for all Israel, for their elders and for their heads, and for their judges and for their officers, and said unto them, I am old and well stricken in years: 3 and ye have seen all that Jehovah your God hath done unto all these nations because of you; for [d]Jehovah your God, he it is that hath fought for you. 4 Behold, [e]I have allotted unto you these nations that remain, to be an inheritance for your tribes, from the Jordan, with all the nations that I have cut off, even unto the great sea toward the going down of the sun. 5 And Jehovah your God, he will thrust them out from before you, and drive them from out of your sight; and [f]ye shall possess their land, as Jehovah your God spake unto you. 6 [g]Therefore be ye very courageous to keep and to do [h]all that is written in the book of the law of Moses, that ye turn not aside therefrom to the right hand or to the left; 7 that ye come not among these nations, these that remain among you; [i]neither make mention of the name of their gods, nor [k]cause to swear *by them*, neither [l]serve them, nor bow down yourselves unto them; 8 but cleave unto Jehovah your God, as ye have done unto this day. 9 [m]For Jehovah [2]hath driven out from before you great nations and strong: but as for you, [n]no man hath stood before you unto this day. 10 [o]One man of you [2]shall chase a thousand; for Jehovah your God, [p]he it is that fighteth for you, as he spake unto you. 11 Take good heed therefore unto yourselves, that ye love Jehovah your God. 12 Else if ye do at all go back, and [q]cleave unto the remnant of these nations, even these that remain among you, and make [r]marriages with them, and go in unto them, and they to you; 13 know for a certainty that Jehovah your God will no more drive these nations from out of your sight; but they [s]shall be a snare and a trap unto you, and a scourge in your sides, and thorns in your eyes, until ye perish from off this good land which Jehovah your God hath given you.

14 And, behold, this day [t]I am going the way of all the earth: and ye know in all your hearts and in all your souls, [u]that not one thing hath failed of all the good things which Jehovah your God spake concerning you; all are come to pass unto you, not one

[a] Gen. 31. 47–49
[b] ch. 21. 44
[c] ch. 24. 1
[d] Dt. 1. 30
[e] Ex. 23. 30
[f] Num. 33. 53
[g] Dt. 5. 32
[h] ch. 1. 7
[i] Ex. 23. 13; Ps. 16. 4
[k] Dt. 6. 13; 10. 20
[l] Ex. 20. 5
[m] Ex. 23. 23, 30
[n] Dt. 7. 24
[o] Lev. 26. 8; Dt. 28. 7
[p] ver. 3
[q] Ex. 34. 15, 16; Ps. 106. 34, 35
[r] Dt. 7. 3, 4; Ezr. 9. 2; Neh. 13. 25
[s] Ex. 23. 33; 34. 12; Dt. 7. 16
[t] 1 K. 2. 2
[u] ch. 21. 45

[1] That is, Witness.
[2] Or, *hath chased*

thing hath failed thereof. 15 And it shall come to pass, that as all the good things are come upon you of which Jehovah your God spake unto you, [a]so will Jehovah bring upon you all the evil things, until he have destroyed you from off this good land which Jehovah your God hath given you. 16 [b]When ye transgress the covenant of Jehovah your God, which he commanded you, and go and serve other gods, and bow down yourselves to them; then will the anger of Jehovah be kindled against you, and ye shall perish quickly from off the good land which he hath given unto you.

24 [c]And Joshua gathered all the tribes of Israel to Shechem, and called for the elders of Israel, and for their heads, and for their judges, and for their officers; and they presented themselves before God. 2 And Joshua said unto all the people, Thus saith Jehovah, the God of Israel, Your fathers dwelt of old time beyond the River, even [d]Terah, the father of Abraham, and the father of Nahor: and they served other gods. 3 [e]And I took your father Abraham from beyond the River, and led him throughout all the land of Canaan, and [f]multiplied his seed, and gave him [g]Isaac. 4 And I gave unto Isaac [h]Jacob and Esau: and [i]I gave unto Esau mount Seir, to possess it; and [k]Jacob and his children went down into Egypt. 5 And [l]I sent Moses and Aaron, and I plagued Egypt, according to that which I did in the midst thereof: and afterward I brought you out. 6 And I brought your fathers out of Egypt: and [m]ye came unto the sea; and the Egyptians pursued after your fathers with chariots and with horsemen unto the Red Sea. 7 And when they cried out unto Jehovah, he put darkness between you and the Egyptians, and brought the sea upon them, and covered them; and your eyes saw what I did in Egypt: and [n]ye dwelt in the wilderness many days. 8 And [o]I brought you into the land of the Amorites, that dwelt beyond the Jordan: and they fought with you; and I gave them into your hand, and ye possessed their land; and I destroyed them from before you. 9 Then [p]Balak the son of Zippor, king of Moab, arose and fought against Israel: and he sent and called Balaam the son of Beor to curse you: 10 but I would not hearken unto Balaam; therefore he blessed you still: so I delivered you out of his hand. 11 And [q]ye went over the Jordan, and came unto Jericho: and the men of Jericho fought against you, [r]the Amorite, and the Perizzite, and the Canaanite, and the Hittite, and the Girgashite, the Hivite, and the Jebusite; and [s]I delivered them into your hand. 12 And I [t]sent the hornet before you, which drove them out from before you, even the two kings of the Amorites; [u]not with thy sword, nor with thy bow. 13 [v]And I gave you a land whereon thou hadst not labored, and cities which ye built not, and ye dwell therein; of vineyards and oliveyards which ye planted not do ye eat.

14 [x]Now therefore fear Jehovah, and serve him in sincerity and in truth; and put away the gods which your fathers served beyond the River, and in Egypt; and serve ye Jehovah. 15 And if it seem evil unto you to serve Jehovah, choose you this day whom ye will serve; whether the gods which your fathers served that were beyond the River, or the gods of the Amorites, in whose land ye dwell: but as for me and my house, we will serve Jehovah.

16 And the people answered and said, Far be it from us that we should forsake Jehovah, to serve other gods; 17 for Jehovah our God, he it is that brought us and our fathers up out of the land of Egypt, from the house of [1]bondage, and that did those great signs in our sight, and preserved us in all the way wherein we went, and among all the peoples through the midst of whom we passed; 18 and Jehovah drove out from before us all the peoples, even the Amorites that dwelt in the land: therefore we also will serve Jehovah; for he is our God.

19 And Joshua said unto the people, Ye cannot serve Jehovah; [y]for he is a holy God; he is [z]a jealous God; [a]he will not forgive your transgression nor your sins. 20 [b]If ye forsake Jehovah, and serve foreign gods, then he will turn

[1] Heb. *bondmen.*

[a] Lev. 26. 14-33; Dt. 28. 15
[b] Dt. 4. 25, 26
[c] ch. 23. 2
[d] Gen. 11. 27-32
[e] Gen. 12. 1; 24. 7
[f] Gen. 15. 5
[g] Gen. 21. 3
[h] Gen. 25. 25, 26
[i] Dt. 2. 5
[k] Gen. 46. 6, 7
[l] Ex. 4. 14-17
[m] Ex. 14. 2-31
[n] Dt. 1. 46; 2. 14
[o] Num. 21. 21-35
[p] Num. 22. 2
[q] ch. 3. 16, 17
[r] Ex. 23. 23, 28; Dt. 7. 1
[s] Ex. 23. 31
[t] Ex. 23. 28; Dt. 7. 20
[u] Ps. 44. 3
[v] Dt. 6. 10, 11
[x] Dt. 10. 12; 18. 13; 1 S. 12. 24
[y] Lev. 19. 2; 20. 7, 26
[z] Ex. 20. 5; 34. 14
[a] Ex. 23. 21
[b] Dt. 4. 25, 29

and do you evil, and consume you, after that he hath done you good. 21 And the people said unto Joshua, Nay; but we will serve Jehovah. 22 And Joshua said unto the people, Ye are witnesses against yourselves that ye have chosen you Jehovah, to serve him. And they said, We are witnesses. 23 Now therefore put away, *said he*, the foreign gods which are among you, and [a] incline your heart unto Jehovah, the God of Israel. 24 [b] And the people said unto Joshua, Jehovah our God will we serve, and unto his voice will we hearken. 25 [c] So Joshua made a covenant with the people that day, and set them a statute and an ordinance in Shechem. 26 And Joshua wrote these words in the book of the law of God; and he took a great stone, and set it up there under the oak that was [1] by the sanctuary of Jehovah. 27 And Joshua said unto all the people, Behold, [d] this stone shall be a witness against us; for it hath heard all the words of Jehovah which he spake unto us: it shall be therefore a witness against you, lest ye deny your God. 28 So Joshua sent the people away, every man unto his inheritance.

29 And it came to pass after these things, that Joshua the son of Nun, the servant of Jehovah, died, being a hundred and ten years old. 30 And they buried him in the border of his inheritance in [e] Timnath-serah, which is in the hill-country of Ephraim, on the north of the mountain of Gaash. 31 And Israel served Jehovah all the days of Joshua, and all the days of the elders that outlived Joshua, and had known all the work of Jehovah, that he had wrought for Israel.

32 [f] And the bones of Joseph, which the children of Israel brought up out of Egypt, buried they in Shechem, in the parcel of ground [g] which Jacob bought of the sons of Hamor the father of Shechem for a hundred pieces of money: and they became the inheritance of the children of Joseph. 33 And Eleazar the son of Aaron died; and they buried him in [2] the hill of [h] Phinehas his son, which was given him in the hill-country of Ephraim.

[a] 1 K. 8. 57, 58; Ps. 119. 36; 141. 4
[b] Ex. 19. 8; 24. 3, 7; Dt. 5. 27
[c] Ex. 24. 8
[d] ch. 22. 27, 34

[e] ch. 19. 50
[f] Gen. 50. 24, 25; Ex. 13. 19; Acts 7. 15, 16
[g] Gen. 33. 19

[h] ch. 22. 13

[1] Or, *in*

[2] Or, *Gibeah of Phinehas*